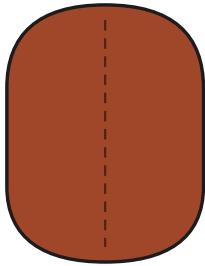


Elytra body ×1

reddish-brown · the wing-cases · actual size



dashed = centre line (guide, don't cut)

Fan antennae ×2

orange-brown · the signature fans · actual size

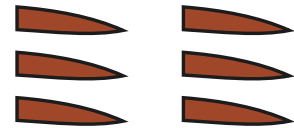
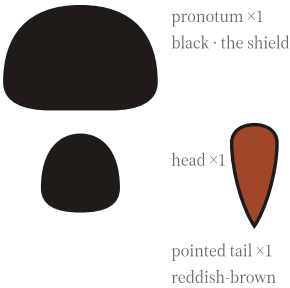


little fans that open at the front

These sniff the air. On the finished bug they spread forward from the head like two open hand-fans.

Head, thorax & legs

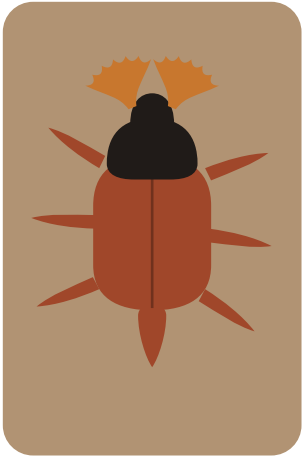
black & reddish-brown · actual size



legs ×6 · reddish-brown · three each side

Finished!

the same pieces, assembled



brown body · black head · orange fan antennae

The real thing



Melolontha melolontha — the maybug, also called the cockchafer. Note the fans.

Photo © entomolojosh (Josh Boe), CC BY, via iNaturalist.
Spud Wood, Cheshire — about 18 km from Manchester.

Did you know?

- It flies at dusk on warm May nights — and bonks windows.
- Its white grubs live in the soil 3–4 years, eating roots.
- The fan antennae sniff the air — bigger fans on the males.
- Once so common they were collected by the bucketful.
- Big and clumsy, but harmless — it can't sting or bite.

How to make it

from your felt squares

- 1 Trace each shape onto the right felt colour.
- 2 Cut out all 12 pieces.
- 3 Build it on the mat →

Felt squares you'll use:

-  reddish-brown — elytra, legs, tail
-  black — head & pronotum
-  orange-brown — the 2 fan antennae

Brown soil mat/pouch is premade.

Build it

lay the pieces on the mat

- 1 Lay the brown mat down — that's the soil.
- 2 Place the reddish-brown elytra in the middle.
- 3 Add the black pronotum & head at the front.

Nothing is fixed — the pieces just sit like a jigsaw.

...and again

it's a puzzle, not a glue-up

- 4 Spread the two orange fan antennae out at the front.
- 5 Tuck the 6 legs under — three each side.
- 6 Add the pointed tail, then take it apart and rebuild!

Fan the antennae a little each time — no two builds are alike.

At a glance

12 felt pieces

- 1 elytra (reddish-brown)
- 1 pronotum (black)
- 1 head (black)
- 2 fan antennae (orange)
- 6 legs (reddish-brown)
- 1 pointed tail (reddish-brown)

Finished size

≈ 5 × 3.5 cm (with antennae)

Theme: Underground. Collect the burying beetle and ant too.



Make your own
Maybug
Instructions

A Giant Insect World felt puzzle
build it · take it apart · build it again



FuzzleWorld

downloadable felt puzzle kits

Collect the set

Meadow · Aquatic · Underground

maybug · burying beetle · ant
ladybird · dragonfly · more...

Species: M. melolontha · Photo ©
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Giant Insect World